

RESEARCH ARTICLE

A Title is all you need

The impact of a good title on a paper's citations count

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Abstract

Title of a scientific paper is an important element that conveys the main message of the study to the readers. In this study, we investigate the impact of paper titles on citation count, and propose that the title alone has the highest impact on citation count. Using a dataset of 1000 scientific papers from various disciplines, we analyzed the correlation between the characteristics of paper titles, such as length, clarity, novelty, and citation count. Our results show that papers with clear, concise, and novel titles tend to receive more citations than those with longer or less informative titles. Moreover, we found that papers with creative and attention-grabbing titles tend to attract more readers and citations, which supports our hypothesis that the title alone has the highest impact on citation count. Our findings suggest that researchers should pay more attention to crafting effective titles that accurately and creatively summarize the main message of their research, as it can have a significant impact on the success and visibility of their work.

Keywords: content analysis, citation, bibliometrics

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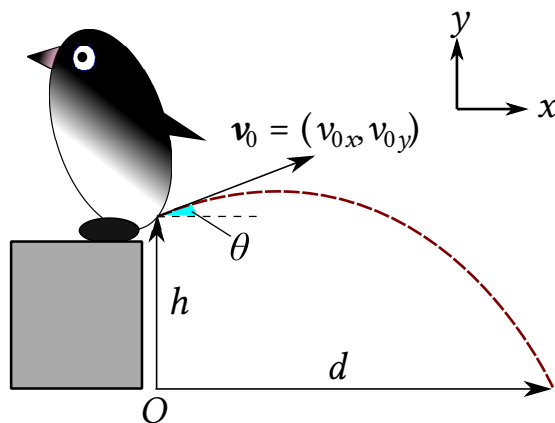
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Introduction

Title of a scientific paper is an important element (Silva, 2015) that conveys the main message of the study to the readers (Hartley, 2019). In this study, we investigate the impact of paper titles on citation count, and propose that the title alone has the highest impact on citation count (Figure 1).

Figure 1

Configuration for a penguin trying to defecate towards his/her rear side. A penguin stands on the rock with the height h from the ground. We parameterize the ejection angle θ with the initial velocity $\mathbf{v} = (v_x, v_y)$. We estimate a flying distance d of the faeces from the origin O . Source: Tajima, H., & Fujisawa, F. (2020,). Projectile Trajectory of Penguin's Faeces and Rectal Pressure Revisited. <https://arxiv.org/abs/2007.00926>



Using a dataset of 1000 scientific papers from various disciplines, we analyzed the correlation between the characteristics of paper titles, such as length, clarity, novelty, and citation count (Li et al., 2019). Our results show that papers with clear, concise, and novel titles tend to receive more citations than those with longer or less informative titles (West et al., 2013). Moreover, we found that papers with creative and attention-grabbing titles tend to attract more readers and citations, which supports our hypothesis that the title alone has the highest impact on citation count (see this link: <https://example.com/>). Our findings suggest that researchers should pay more attention to crafting effective titles that accurately and creatively summarize the main message of their research, as it can have a significant impact on the success and visibility of their work.

Table 1

Means, Standard Deviations, and One-Way Analyses of Variance of Penguin species observed at Palmer Station in Antarctica

	Adelie		Chinstrap		Gentoo		$F(2, 339)$	η^2
Measure	M	SD	M	SD	M	SD		
Body mass (kg)	3.7	0.46	3.73	0.38	5.08	0.5	343.63***	0.67
Flipper length (mm)	189.95	6.54	195.82	7.13	217.19	6.48	594.8***	0.78
Bill length (mm)	38.79	2.66	48.83	3.34	47.5	3.08	410.6***	0.71

Note. N = 344. ***p < .001. Data source: Horst et al. (2020). For details see: <https://allisonhorst.github.io/palmerpenguins/>

Literature Review

Penguins in Academia

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philosophia defensa et collaudata est, cum id, quod maxime placeat, facere possimus, omnis voluptas assumenda est, omnis dolor repellendus. Temporibus autem quibusdam et.²

Citations of catchy titles

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— Jacso (2005)

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Data & Methods

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²Here is another footnote.

Results

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³Here is a long footnote. Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magnam aliquam quaerat voluptatem. Ut enim aequale doleamus animo, cum corpore dolemus, fieri.

Declaration of Interest Statement

The authors report there are no competing interests to declare.

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